

APPLIED ENGLISH

Unit-II: Vocabulary

Comprehensive Study Notes

As per HPU BCA Semester-I Syllabus

1. Change the Number (Singular to Plural)

1.1 Rules for Changing Number

S.No.	Rule	Singular	Plural
1	Most nouns add -s	book, pen	books, pens
2	Nouns ending in s, x, z, ch, sh add -es	bus, box, watch	buses, boxes, watches
3	Nouns ending in y (consonant + y) change y to i and add -es	baby, city	babies, cities
4	Nouns ending in y (vowel + y) add -s	boy, key	boys, keys
5	Nouns ending in o add -es	potato, hero	potatoes, heroes
6	Nouns ending in f / fe change to v and add -es	leaf, knife	leaves, knives
7	Irregular plurals (no fixed rule)	child, man	children, men

1.2 Common Singular–Plural Pairs

Singular	Plural
Apple	Apples
Child	Children
Man	Men
Woman	Women
Foot	Feet

Tooth	Teeth
Mouse	Mice
Ox	Oxen
Goose	Geese
Leaf	Leaves
Knife	Knives
City	Cities
Doll	Dolls
Bush	Bushes
Scissor	Scissors

1.3 Practice Exercises

Exercise 1: Change the Number

Singular	Plural
Doll	Dolls
Bush	Bushes
City	Cities
Foot	Feet
Child	Children
Man	Men
Woman	Women
Tooth	Teeth

Leaf	Leaves
Hero	Heroes

Exercise 2: Change the Number in Sentences

1. That boy has hurt his foot. → **Those boys have hurt their feet.**
2. The cook was ready to prepare the dish. → **The cooks were ready to prepare the dishes.**
3. He took a knife and cut the potato. → **They took knives and cut the potatoes.**
4. The fairy told the child a story. → **The fairies told the children stories.**
5. The mouse entered the shop. → **The mice entered the shops.**

2. Change the Gender (Masculine to Feminine)

2.1 Common Masculine–Feminine Pairs

Masculine	Feminine
Actor	Actress
Boy	Girl
Brother	Sister
Father	Mother
Husband	Wife
King	Queen
Man	Woman
Uncle	Aunt
Son	Daughter
Nephew	Niece
Grandfather	Grandmother
Prince	Princess
Sir	Madam
Horse	Mare
Peacock	Peahen
Cock	Hen

Ox	Cow
Fox	Vixen
Poet	Poetess
Landlord	Landlady
Monk	Nun
Emperor	Empress
Hero	Heroine
Manager	Manageress
Priest	Priestess

2.2 Practice Exercises

Exercise 1: Change the Gender

Masculine	Feminine
Nephew	Niece
Horse	Mare
Father	Mother
His	Her
Son	Daughter
Fox	Vixen
Poet	Poetess
He	She

Exercise 2: Change the Gender in Sentences

1. My landlord lives with his mother and his aunt. → **My landlady lives with her father and her uncle.**
2. The boys went to the zoo. They saw a lioness and a tiger. → **The girls went to the zoo. They saw a lion and a tigress.**
3. The prince was riding a white mare. → **The princess was riding a white horse.**
4. My brother is a poet. → **My sister is a poetess.**
5. The king was a widower. → **The queen was a widow.**

3. Words Commonly Misspelt

3.1 Most Commonly Misspelt Words

Correct Spelling	Common Mistake
Accommodation	Accomodation
Business	Buisness
Committee	Comittee
Definitely	Definately
Embarrass	Embarass
Independent	Independant
Necessary	Neccessary
Occurred	Occured
Separate	Seperate
Successful	Sucessful
Tomorrow	Tommorrow
Writing	Writting
Believe	Beleive
Receive	Recieve
Appearance	Appearence
Beginning	Begining
Calendar	Calender

Convenient	Convenient
Environment	Enviroment
Government	Goverment
Knowledge	Knowlege
Maintenance	Maintainance
Occasion	Occassion
Pronunciation	Pronounciation
Recommend	Recomend

3.2 Tips to Avoid Common Spelling Mistakes

- **Double letters:** accommodation, committee, embarrass, necessary, tomorrow
- **i before e except after c:** believe, receive, achieve
- **Silent letters:** write, thought, know, answer
- **Add -ing carefully:** writing (not writting), beginning (not begining)

3.3 Practice Exercises

Incorrect	Correct Spelling
Accomodation	Accommodation
Definate	Definitely
Sucess	Success
Seperate	Separate
Beleave	Believe
Neccessary	Necessary

4. Antonyms (Opposites)

Antonym: A word that has the opposite meaning of another word.

4.1 Common Antonyms

Word	Antonym
Above	Below
Accept	Refuse
Begin	End
Bright	Dull
Clean	Dirty
Deep	Shallow
Early	Late
Full	Empty
Light	Dark
Open	Close
Hot	Cold
Fast	Slow
Strong	Weak
Big	Small
Tall	Short
Beautiful	Ugly

Rich	Poor
Hard	Soft
Fat	Thin
Bitter	Sweet
Empty	Full
East	West
Good	Bad
Happy	Sad
Start	End

4.2 Practice Exercises

Exercise 1: Write the Antonyms

Word	Antonym
Happy	Sad
Hot	Cold
Fast	Slow
Dark	Light
Strong	Weak
Beautiful	Ugly
Rich	Poor
Hard	Soft
Fat	Thin

Bitter	Sweet
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Exercise 2: Fill in the Blanks

1. The room was not bright; it was **dull**.
2. She was not happy; she was **sad**.
3. The weather was not hot; it was **cold**.
4. The box was not empty; it was **full**.
5. He was not strong; he was **weak**.

5. Synonyms

Synonym: A word that has the same or nearly the same meaning as another word.

5.1 Common Synonyms

Word	Synonyms
Abandon	Leave, Desert, Forsake
Brave	Courageous, Fearless, Valiant
Create	Make, Build, Construct
Difficult	Hard, Tough, Arduous
Enough	Sufficient, Adequate, Ample
Friendly	Kind, Amiable, Cordial
Help	Assist, Aid, Support
Imagine	Picture, Visualize, Envision
Kind	Caring, Compassionate, Gentle
Magnificent	Grand, Splendid, Majestic
Happy	Joyful, Cheerful, Delighted
Big	Large, Huge, Enormous
Fast	Quick, Rapid, Speedy
Dark	Dim, Gloomy, Shadowy
Strong	Powerful, Mighty, Potent
Beautiful	Pretty, Attractive, Gorgeous

Intelligent	Smart, Clever, Wise
End	Finish, Complete, Conclude
Aim	Goal, Objective, Target
Silent	Quiet, Still, Calm

5.2 Practice Exercises

Exercise 1: Write the Synonyms

Word	Synonym(s)
Happy	Joyful / Cheerful / Delighted
Big	Large / Huge / Enormous
Fast	Quick / Rapid / Speedy
Brave	Courageous / Fearless / Valiant
Kind	Caring / Compassionate / Gentle
Difficult	Hard / Tough / Arduous
Help	Assist / Aid / Support
Beautiful	Pretty / Attractive / Gorgeous
End	Finish / Complete / Conclude
Aim	Goal / Objective / Target

Exercise 2: Replace with a Synonym

1. The *brave* soldier fought for his country. → **courageous / fearless**
2. She is a *kind* person. → **caring / compassionate**
3. The task was *difficult*. → **hard / tough**
4. He is very *intelligent*. → **smart / clever / wise**

5. The view was *beautiful*. → **pretty / gorgeous / attractive**

6. Determiners

6.1 Definition

Determiners are words placed before nouns to clarify what the noun refers to.

6.2 Types of Determiners

Type	Determiners	Example
Articles	a, an, the	The sun rises in the east.
Demonstratives	this, that, these, those	This book is mine.
Possessives	my, your, his, her, its, our, their	My pen is red.
Quantifiers	some, any, many, much, few, little, several	Some people like coffee.
Numbers	one, two, three, first, second, third	The first prize is special.

6.3 Rules for Using Determiners

- **a / an** — used with singular countable nouns
 - *a* + consonant sound: a book, a pen, a university
 - *an* + vowel sound: an apple, an umbrella, an hour
- **the** — used when referring to something specific or already known
- **this / these** — for things near in distance or time
- **that / those** — for things far in distance or time
- **some / any** — for unspecified quantities; *some* in positive, *any* in negative and questions

6.4 Practice Exercises

Exercise 1: Fill in the Blanks

1. **An** apple a day keeps the doctor away.
2. **The** sun rises in the east.
3. **This / That** book is mine.
4. **Some / Many** people like coffee.
5. **My / Your / His / Her** pen is red.
6. I need **some** water.
7. **The first** prize is special.
8. **Many / Several** students are absent today.

Exercise 2: Choose the Correct Determiner

1. (A / **An**) elephant is a large animal.
2. (**Some** / Any) people came to the party.
3. (This / **These**) books are mine.
4. (A / **The**) sun is shining brightly.
5. (My / **Her**) name is Priya.

7. Practice Questions (All Topics)

Exercise 1: Change the Number

Singular	Plural
Child	Children
Goose	Geese
Scissor	Scissors
Foot	Feet
Tooth	Teeth

Exercise 2: Change the Gender

Masculine	Feminine
He	She
Son	Daughter
Fox	Vixen
Poet	Poetess
Uncle	Aunt

Exercise 3: Correct the Spelling

Incorrect	Correct
Accomodation	Accommodation

Buisness	Business
Definately	Definitely
Seperate	Separate
Sucess	Success

Exercise 4: Antonyms

Word	Antonym
Fat	Thin
Bitter	Sweet
Empty	Full
East	West
Good	Bad

Exercise 5: Synonyms

Word	Synonym(s)
End	Finish / Complete
Strong	Powerful / Mighty
Aim	Goal / Target
Silent	Quiet / Still
Brave	Courageous / Fearless

Exercise 6: Determiners

1. **An** elephant is a large animal.

2. **The** book on the table is mine.
3. **Some / Many** people like to travel.
4. I need **some** milk.
5. **The** sun is very bright.

8. Quick Revision

8.1 Change the Number — Key Points

- Most nouns: add -s (book → books)
- Ending in s, x, z, ch, sh: add -es (bus → buses)
- Ending in y (consonant + y): y → ies (city → cities)
- Irregular: child → children, man → men, foot → feet

8.2 Change the Gender — Key Points

- He → She
- Son → Daughter
- Father → Mother
- Uncle → Aunt
- Nephew → Niece
- King → Queen
- Prince → Princess

8.3 Common Misspelt Words — Key Points

- Double letters: accommodation, committee, necessary
- i before e except after c: believe, receive
- Silent letters: write, thought, know

8.4 Antonyms — Key Pairs

- Happy → Sad
- Hot → Cold
- Fast → Slow
- Strong → Weak
- Beautiful → Ugly
- Rich → Poor
- Hard → Soft

- Empty → Full

8.5 Synonyms — Key Pairs

- Happy → Joyful, Cheerful
- Big → Large, Huge
- Fast → Quick, Rapid
- Brave → Courageous, Fearless
- Kind → Caring, Compassionate
- Difficult → Hard, Tough
- Help → Assist, Aid

8.6 Determiners — Key Points

- **a / an** — singular countable nouns (a + consonant, an + vowel)
- **the** — specific nouns
- **this / these** — near
- **that / those** — far
- **some / any** — unspecified quantities

9. HPU BCA Exam Tips for Unit-II

1. Change the Number: Memorize irregular plurals (child → children)
2. Change the Gender: Practice common masculine–feminine pairs
3. Misspelt Words: Focus on commonly confused words
4. Antonyms / Synonyms: Build vocabulary regularly
5. Determiners: Understand when to use a / an / the
6. Time Management: Do not spend more than 20 minutes on this unit
7. Practice: Solve previous year papers regularly

End of Unit-II Notes